

Activity 3 — Role-Play Observer Checklist

Diagnosing Customer Needs at a Growing SME — TechNova Account Review

Focus of this observation	Needs discovery — open questioning, active listening and the four levels
You are observing	Role A — the TechNova Account Manager
Setup	Pairs. Role A = TechNova Account Manager, Role B = Daniel Lim. Assessor-style observer optional.
Duration	20 minutes

Observer: _____ Performer: _____ Round: 1 / 2

Tick **DONE** only where you actually saw the behaviour. 'What good looks like' is the standard — anything less is **NOT YET**.

Cod e	What to observe	What good looks like	Done	Not yet
A2	Opened by acknowledging the relationship	Referenced the six-year history before raising any problem or product.		
K1	Asked open questions first	Used what / how / tell me / walk me through. Closed questions only to confirm specifics.		
K1	Paraphrased each answer before moving on	Said the answer back in their own words and waited for confirmation.		
A2	Surfaced the REAL brief	Got to the MD deadline at month end — not just the three stated complaints.		
A2	Identified an emotional need, not only functional ones	Recognised that Daniel is exposed in front of his MD, not merely inconvenienced by slow uploads.		
A2	Did NOT propose an upgrade in the first 4 minutes	Diagnosed before prescribing; no early sales pitch.		
A2	Raised the 15-seat breach as a discovery, not an accusation	Framed it as 'your growth outran the plan we sold you' rather than a contract violation.		
A2	Proposed an action at each of the four levels	Understand → meet the basic need → outside the box → extra mile (the MD's report).		

Strongest moment — what worked, and why

One thing to change in the next round

The performer's own view (ask them first, before you give feedback)

Check your work: Your needs analysis has at least one emotional need identified, all four levels populated, and your role-play partner confirms you surfaced the MD deadline as the real brief.